

LIVE



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ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

27th WEEK



INDIA-CHINA BORDER DISPUTE

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... INDIA AND ITS NEIGHBORHOOD- RELATIONS.

1

Step back

Sustained tension at the Bhutan tri-junction
suits neither China nor India

The boundary stand-off with China at the Doka La tri-junction with Bhutan is by all accounts unprecedented; it demands calmer counsel on all sides. The tri-junction stretch of the boundary at Sikkim, though contested, has witnessed far fewer tensions than the western sector of the India-China boundary even as India and Bhutan have carried on separate negotiations with China. China's action of sending People's Liberation Army construction teams with earth moving equipment to forcibly build a road upsets a carefully preserved peace. In fact, during Chinese President Xi Jinping's visit in 2014 the stretch was opened as an alternative route to Kailash Mansarovar for Indian pilgrims as a confidence-building measure. That the PLA decided to undertake the action just as the year's first group of pilgrims was reaching Nathu La cannot be a coincidence. Moreover, it came only days after Prime Minister Narendra Modi's bilateral meeting with President Xi in Kazakhstan. The warmth that officials reported at the meeting was obviously misleading, and it is important for India and China to accept that relations have deteriorated steadily since Mr. Xi's 2014 visit. The stand-off comes after a series of setbacks to bilateral ties. Delhi has expressed disappointment over China's rejection of its concerns on sovereignty issues, and refusal to corner Pakistan on cross-border terrorism or help India's bid for Nuclear Suppliers Group membership. In turn, India's spurning of the Belt and Road Initiative and cooperation with the U.S. on maritime issues has not played well in China – neither has the uptick in rhetoric, including statements from the Arunachal Pradesh Chief Minister questioning India's "One China Policy" on Tibet, and from Army chief Bipin Rawat on India being prepared for a two-and-a-half front war.

These issues have to be addressed through sustained dialogue. In the immediate term, however, talks must focus on defusing the tensions at the tri-junction. China has made the withdrawal of Indian troops a precondition

THE  HINDU

Date : 3rd July, 2017



AFGHANISTAN

Jammu
and
Kashmir

CHINA

3,488 kms

Himachal
Pradesh

PAKISTAN

Uttarakhand

NEPAL

INDIA

Sikkim

BHUTAN

Arunachal
Pradesh

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal



Jammu & Kashmir	1,597
Arunachal Pradesh	1,126
Uttarakhand	345
Sikkim	220
Himachal Pradesh	200
TOTAL	3,488



AFGHANISTAN

Jammu
and
Kashmir

Western Sector

CHINA

Himachal
Pradesh

Middle Sector

PAKISTAN

Uttarakhand

Eastern Sector

NEPAL

BHUTAN

Arunachal
Pradesh

INDIA

Sikkim

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal



ISSUE NO: 1

WESTERN SECTOR



- *In 1865, W. H. Johnson, a civil servant with the Survey of India proposed the "Johnson Line", which put Aksai Chin in Kashmir.*
- *China has got reservations over this line.*
- *India sticks to the Johnson Line.*
- *This separates Jammu & Kashmir with Xinjiang Province of China.*
- *India accuses China of illegally occupying Aksai Chin as well as parts of Ladakh region.*
- *1962 war saw fierce fighting between the two sides.*
- *Tense stand-offs occasionally take place.*



I R A N

A F G H A N I S T A N

C H I N A

P A K I S T A N

N E P A L

B H U T A N

S A U D I
A R A B I A

O M A N

B A N G L A D E S H

M Y A N M A R
(B U R M A)

A R A B I A N S E A

B A Y O F B E N G A L



ISSUE NO: 2

MIDDLE SECTOR



- Here the border is least controversial.
- Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand abet the boundary.
- Both sides do not have much disagreement over this area.



ISSUE NO: 3

EASTERN SECTOR

SIKKIM REGION



- On March 17, 1890, top officials from British India and China signed a treaty to demarcate the boundary between Tibet and Sikkim.
- The boundary of Sikkim and Tibet shall be the crest of the mountain range separating the waters flowing into the Sikkim Teesta and its affluents from the waters flowing into the Tibetan Mochu and northwards into other rivers of Tibet.



ISSUE NO: 4

EASTERN SECTOR

ARUNACHAL REGION



- In 1913, Tibet declared independence
- But, the subsequent Chinese government did not recognize this.
- 1914 Shimla Accord defined McMahon line as the new boundary between Tibet and British India (China initiated but not signed)
- Chinese map shows some 65,000 sq km of the territory south of the line as part of the Tibet Autonomous Region, which they call it as South Tibet.

- China says Tibet was not sovereign and did not have the power to conclude treaties.
- This is the reason, why China issues stapled visas to people from Arunachal Pradesh.

C H I N A



N E P A L

TAWANG

ARUNACHAL
PRADESH

B H U T A N

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

Bay of Bengal



CHINA

SIKKIM

BHUTAN

NEPAL

INDIA

BANGLADESH

**MYANMAR
(BURMA)**



DOKLAM CONTROVERSY

BHUTAN'S VIEW



- Doklam is also known as Donglong area of the Sikkim sector.
- China was constructing motorable road from Dokola towards Bhutan army camp.
- It affects the boundary between the two countries.
- Bhutan asked Beijing to restore status quo by stopping the work.
- Donglong is a tri-junction area near the Chumbi Valley.
- It is under China's control, however, Bhutan claims sovereignty over the area.
- Both have written agreements during 1988 and 1998, stating that the two sides agree to maintain tranquillity in their border areas pending a final settlement on the boundary question.
- It was also decided to maintain status quo on the boundary as before March, 1959.





DOKLAM CONTROVERSY

CHINA's VIEW



- China says that its personnel are operating in Chinese territory.
- China also says Indian troops have transgressed into Chinese territory.
- It says Sikkim sector of the border has a clear legal basis.
- According to the Convention between China and Great Britain in 1890, the boundary of Sikkim and Tibet shall be the crest of the mountain range separating border with water flows towards the Teesta.



LOW ON INDIA-CHINA RELATIONS



- 1** Strengthening the bonds between India and USA not palatable to China.
- 2** Joint Malabar Exercises with US and its traditional ally Japan.
- 3** China's objection for India's entry into Nuclear Suppliers Group.
- 4** India's statements with regard to South China Sea are not acceptable to China.
- 5** CPEC involves sovereignty issues within J&K.
- 6** China's objection for Masood Azhar designating as a terrorist.
- 7** Stapled visas for the visitors from Arunachal Pradesh.
- 8** China's close relations with Pakistan, even though it is widely believed that Pakistan is behind aiding and abetting of terrorists.

However, it is very much essential to defuse the tensions between India and China.

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